Health and Safety Responsibilities of Managers & Supervisors Policy

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Chief Operating Officer
Date Ratified	December 6, 2024
Next Review Date	December 2027
Previous Amendments	February 3, 2022; February 7, 2020
Related Document(s)	Appendix: OHSA ss. 25, 26, 27

Policy Summary

This policy outlines the health and safety responsibilities and accountabilities of USC Managers and Supervisors. It sets out the core duties Managers and Supervisors must perform, ties those duties to specific sections of the Occupational Health and Safety Act, describes how performance on these responsibilities is evaluated, and establishes that disciplinary procedures for violations follow the collective agreement between the USC and CUPE Local 2820.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all USC Managers & Supervisors.
- Managers and Supervisors must ensure workplace inspections take place, conduct information sessions (safety talks, staff meetings, tailgate meetings), conduct incident investigations, conduct employee training, correct substandard acts or conditions, commend good health and safety performance, and appoint competent supervision.
- Managers are responsible for sections 25 and 26 of the Occupational Health and Safety Act (and all other applicable legislation); Supervisors are responsible for section 27.
- Manager and Supervisor performance evaluations occur twice each year — a midyear qualitative evaluation and a final quantitative evaluation — following USC's performance appraisal methodology for both management and union staff.
- Each of the seven core responsibilities (inspections, information sessions, incident investigations, training, correcting substandard conditions, commending performance, and appointing competent supervision) is specifically measured in the evaluation.
- Disciplinary procedures for violations of this policy follow the process described in Article 12 of the collective agreement between the USC and CUPE Local 2820.

Knowledge Check

4 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. A Supervisor is unsure which section of the Occupational Health and Safety Act they are specifically responsible for under this policy. Which section applies to Supervisors?

A. Section 27.
B. Section 28.
C. Section 25.
D. Section 26.

Q2. How often are Manager and Supervisor health and safety performance evaluations performed, and in what format?

A. Once a year, quantitative only.

B. Twice a year — a midyear qualitative evaluation and a final quantitative evaluation.

C. Quarterly, qualitative only.

D. Only when requested by Human Resources.

Q3. A Manager repeatedly fails to correct known substandard safety conditions in their department. What governs the disciplinary process for this?

A. Referral directly to Western Campus Police.

B. Immediate termination with no process.

C. Article 12 of the collective agreement between the USC and CUPE Local 2820.

D. A verbal warning only, with no further escalation possible.

Q4. Which of the following is NOT listed as a core Manager/Supervisor responsibility under this policy?

A. Commending employee health and safety performance.

B. Conducting incident investigations.

C. Appointing competent supervision.

D. Personally administering all first aid treatment on-site.

Answer Key

Q1: A — Section 2.3 states Supervisors are responsible for section 27 of the OHSA.

Q2: B — Section 2.4.1 states performance evaluations will be performed twice each year, with a midyear qualitative and a final quantitative evaluation.

Q3: C — Section 3.1 states disciplinary procedures will follow the process described in Article 12 of the collective agreement between the USC and CUPE Local 2820.

Q4: D — Section 2.1 lists seven specific responsibilities (inspections, information sessions, incident investigations, training, correcting substandard conditions, commending performance, and appointing competent supervision) — personally administering first aid is not among them.